Chapter 9: Architecture Capability

Study Guide, based on Mastering the TOGAF Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 9 (pp. 229-245)

Overview

Chapter 9 (pp. 229-245) is about the **Architecture Capability**: an organization's ability to develop, maintain, and govern its Enterprise Architecture (p. 229). Section 9.1 defines it simply as the ability to practice architecture (p. 230). Section 9.2 shows that the capability is built like any other capability, by running through the ADM phases, each with specific focus areas (Table 9-1), and stresses that it is an ongoing discipline, not a project (pp. 230-236). Section 9.3 explains the four **Architecture Purpose Capabilities** from the Leader's Guide (support strategy, portfolio, projects, solution delivery) and how the capability's position and reporting line determine how strategic it is (pp. 236-241). Section 9.4 summarizes (pp. 241-245). Leave with this idea: *where* the capability sits in the organization chart decides whether architecture is proactive and strategic or reactive and solution-focused (pp. 240-241). Chapter 9 is part of the GREEN and GOLD reading tours (p. 229).

> **Reading note:** That the ADM can be used to establish the capability is the Standard's view (p. 230). The four purposes come from the Leader's Guide, a Series Guide (p. 237). Jager adds: which leader suits each purpose (CEO, CIO/CTO, unit manager) (pp. 237-239), the question of whether "solution delivery" EA would be better done by a Solution Architect (p. 238), and the practical note that the ADM steps for the capability often happen in one or two meetings (p. 236).

Detailed Section Breakdown

Chapter Opener (p. 229)

- **Definition and scope.** The ability to develop, maintain, and govern the EA. It includes governance, organizational structures, processes, roles, responsibilities, and skills, so that architecture work is standardized, repeatable, and aligned with strategy (p. 229).
- **Benefits.** Responding to change, managing complexity, better decisions, and properly governed and resourced initiatives (p. 229).

9.1 The Ability to Practice Architecture (p. 230)

- **A loose definition of capability:** "The ability of an organization to do something", where *something* here is "to practice architecture" (p. 230).

9.2 Creating the Architecture Capability (pp. 230-236)

- **Same as any capability.** "As with any business capability, the establishment of an Enterprise Architecture Capability can be supported by the TOGAF Architecture Development Method", especially Phase A (p. 230).
- **Ongoing discipline.** Not a separate phase or stand-alone project, but an ongoing discipline that provides context, environment, and resources (p. 231).
- **All four domains.** Like any capability, it needs Business, Data, Application, and Technology design (p. 231).

ADM phase	Focus areas for creating the Architecture Capability (Table 9-1)	Page
A: Architecture Vision	Define the project (stakeholders, which largely decides positioning); identify stakeholder concerns and business requirements; identify business goals and drivers (also shapes positioning); define scope (a high-level plan); define organization-wide constraints; perform an Architecture Maturity Assessment	pp. 231-233
B: Business Architecture	Agree on a common language; define the process (an adapted ADM, using only the useful parts); identify views and viewpoints (don't forget governance); decide on the framework (deliverables and their requirements); define performance metrics; agree on the Governance Framework (draw and document it)	pp. 231, 233-234
C and D: Data, Application, Technology	Specify and govern the Architecture Repository structure (the metamodel); define requirements for deliverables (create, maintain, publish, distribute, govern; toolset; publishing); define the technology and infrastructure	pp. 231, 234-235
E: Opportunities and Solutions	Determine the organizational change needed	pp. 232, 235
F and G: Migration Planning, Implementation Governance	Govern the organizational change	pp. 232, 235
H: Architecture Change Management	Manage change	pp. 232, 235
Requirements Management	Manage requirements: articulate and align all of them	pp. 232, 236

- **Maturity first.** How the capability can be implemented depends heavily on the organization's maturity level (p. 233; see Ch. 15).
- **Outcome.** The business goals and desired outcomes defined here largely determine the capability's position in the organization (p. 236).

Jager's commentary (author's view): In practice this is less formal. The steps are often agreed in one or two meetings, and the agreements should be recorded and, if possible, signed off by the main sponsor (p. 236).

9.3 Positioning the Architecture Capability (pp. 236-241)

- **Strategic tool advantage.** Organizations that see EA as a strategic business management tool, not a technical instrument, use it to translate strategy into implementation (p. 236).

Purpose (Leader's Guide, Figure 9-1)	What the capability does	Typical scope	Suggested leader / reporting line	Page
Architecture to Support Strategy	Target architectures and roadmaps for changes over 3-10 years. Shapes drivers, goals, objectives, initiatives. "Architecture in its most comprehensive form"	Organization-wide, many programs	CEO or strategy executive	pp. 237, 240
Architecture to Support Portfolio	Supports change initiatives spanning multiple functions, phases, and projects, e.g., a cloud migration portfolio	One portfolio	CIO (or CTO)	pp. 237-238, 240
Architecture to Support Projects	Fits the project delivery method. Clarifies purpose and value, identifies requirements, monitors governance, aligns projects, e.g., moving a CRM to the cloud	One project	CIO/CTO; reporting often to an IT unit manager	pp. 238, 240

Purpose (Leader's Guide, Figure 9-1)	What the capability does	Typical scope	Suggested leader / reporting line	Page
Architecture to Support Solution Delivery	Defines how the change is designed and delivered, with its constraints, controls, and requirements	One project or part of one	Unit manager; IT domain	pp. 238-240

- **Maturity assessment guides positioning.** An Architecture Maturity Assessment indicates where the capability should sit to achieve business goals. Position shows how the organization views architecture (p. 239).
- **Reporting line (Figure 9-2).** "The higher the direct reporting line... the more the Architecture Capability moves toward the strategic side" (pp. 239-240).
- **No right or wrong.** Position depends on the organization's needs (p. 240).
- **The risk of positioning too low.** Toward the operational side, work becomes solution-oriented, reactive, and disconnected from goals and objectives. Architecture risks becoming "a stand-alone entity" (p. 241).
- **Link to roles.** The capability relates directly to TOGAF's architecture roles, which relate to the domains (p. 241; see Ch. 10).

Jager's commentary (author's view): EA that only supports solution delivery "is actually similar to Solution Architecture", so the organization might be better served by a Solution Architect (p. 238). Strategy-level architecture "would benefit greatly from being led by a CEO" (p. 237).

9.4 Summary (pp. 241-245)

- The capability is a must, built via the ADM, and is an ongoing discipline (pp. 241-242).
- The creation steps are listed per phase (pp. 242-244).
- Four ways to position it. Agree on how the organization views it, use a maturity assessment to focus it, and remember that a higher reporting line means more strategic work (pp. 244-245).

Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition	Page
Architecture Capability	The organization's ability to practice (develop, maintain, govern) Enterprise Architecture	pp. 229-230
Capability (loose definition)	The ability of an organization to do something	p. 230
Architecture Maturity Assessment	An assessment of the current maturity of architecture, done in Phase A when creating the capability, which guides positioning	pp. 233, 239
Architecture Purpose Capabilities	The Leader's Guide's four uses: support strategy, portfolio, projects, solution delivery	p. 237
Positioning / reporting line	Where the capability sits in the organization. Higher means more strategic	pp. 239-240

Figures & Tables Referenced

Figure / Table	What it shows	Page
Table 9-1	ADM phases and focus areas for creating the Architecture Capability	pp. 231-232
Figure 9-1	Architecture Purpose Capabilities	p. 237

Figure / Table	What it shows	Page
Figure 9-2	Positioning of the Architecture Capability on an organization chart	p. 240

Self-Check Questions

Q: How does the TOGAF Standard say the Architecture Capability should be created?

A: Like any other business capability, by working through the ADM phases, particularly Phase A (p. 230).

Q: Is establishing the Architecture Capability a one-time project?

A: No. It is an ongoing discipline that provides the context, environment, and resources to govern and deliver architecture (p. 231).

Q: Which Phase A steps most influence where the capability is positioned?

A: Defining the project (its stakeholders) and identifying business goals and drivers (pp. 232-233).

Q: Name the six Phase B focus areas for creating the capability.

A: Agree on a common language; define the process; identify views and viewpoints; decide on the framework; define performance metrics; agree on the Governance Framework (pp. 233-234).

Q: What do Phases C and D focus on when creating the capability?

A: Specifying and governing the Architecture Repository's structure (metamodel), defining requirements for deliverables (including tools and publishing), and defining the technology and infrastructure (pp. 234-235).

Q: Name the four Architecture Purpose Capabilities.

A: Architecture to support strategy, portfolio, projects, and solution delivery (p. 237).

Q: What time horizon does "Architecture to Support Strategy" cover?

A: Three to ten years of organizational change (p. 237).

Q: What happens when the capability is positioned toward the operational side of the organization?

A: Work becomes solution-oriented and reactive, is less connected to goals and strategy, and architecture risks becoming a stand-alone entity (p. 241).

Q: Why does Jager suggest a Solution Architect for "support solution delivery"?

A: EA used only for solution delivery is effectively Solution Architecture (p. 238).

Q: What tool helps decide where the capability's focus should be?

A: An Architecture Maturity Assessment (pp. 233, 239).